

SCAFFOLD

SUPPORTS TERTIARY WHY

FOR WHAT-HOW · HOW-WHAT

The Problem Reframe Deck

A card deck of prompts that pressure-test whether the right problem is being solved. **The reframing question gets asked by the cards**, so it no longer depends on an instinct that drains you.

THE DRAIN

WHY-primaries reflexively ask whether the problem is the real problem; for WHAT-HOW and HOW-WHAT profiles that question rarely arrives unprompted, and enormous execution skill gets spent on precisely solving the wrong thing. The failure is invisible until the excellent solution lands and nothing improves.

WHAT THIS TOOL DOES

The deck supplies the challenge. Ten minutes with five cards, before serious effort is committed, surfaces most of what a purpose review would catch: inherited framings, symptoms dressed as causes, solutions smuggled into problem statements. You do not need the instinct; you need only to answer the cards honestly.

HOW TO USE IT

- 1 **Run the deck before committing effort.** Reframing after execution starts costs ten times more, in work and in morale.
- 2 **Draw five cards, answer in writing.** One or two lines each. Written answers cannot hide behind "we discussed it."
- 3 **Watch for the flinch.** The card you want to skip is usually the one holding a finding.
- 4 **Restate the problem, then proceed.** One sentence, revised or confirmed. Now execute with your full energy, aimed.

Cards from the deck

- 1 Whose problem is this really, and would they describe it this way?
- 2 What would make this problem irrelevant instead of solved?
- 3 What is the problem behind the problem?
- 4 If the obvious fix were forbidden, what would we do instead?
- 5 Are we solving this because it matters, or because we know how?
- 6 What would a skeptic say we are actually optimizing for?

WHAT IT WON'T DO

The deck tests the frame; it cannot supply a vision, and it occasionally concludes the original framing was right, which is a success, not a wasted ten minutes. For genuinely strategic ambiguity, bring the flagged cards to a WHY-primary; you will hand them the exact conversation they are wired for.

IN THE KIT

Reframe card deck (print)

Written-answer sheet

Team facilitation variant

PAIRS WELL WITH

Tool 27 Assumption Audit · **Tool 21** Five-Question Purpose Brief · **Tool 30** Pre-Mortem Protocol